MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCSSS201 - MANUSCRIPTOLOGY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

1. 500 years
2. The Latin word *scriptus* means "written".
3. Writing the text and publishing the text.
4. Manuscript collector.
5. The primary script used in the Andhra Pradesh area is the **Telugu script**.
6. The Sarada script first emerged around the 8th century CE. The script is a descendant of the Gupta script and belongs to the Brahmic family of scripts. It was widely used in the northwestern Indian subcontinent, especially for writing Sanskrit and Kashmiri.
7. In descriptive catalogs, details are presented in a structured and standardized format, typically in a bibliographic record. Librarians and other catalogers follow established rules, such as those in Resource Description and Access (RDA), to ensure consistent and accurate data for users.
8. The most important factor when building a library is understanding and addressing the needs of the community it will serve. Rather than being a static container for books, a modern library must be a flexible and welcoming community hub that meets diverse educational, recreational, and social needs.
9. The life span of manuscripts made from leather and birch bark varies significantly depending on how they were prepared and stored. While both are organic and susceptible to decay, surviving artifacts prove they can last for centuries, and in exceptional conditions, for millennia.
10. There are many effective methods for eradicating worms and insects, ranging from natural remedies and biological controls to chemical treatments and physical barriers. The best method depends on the type of pest, the location (garden, home, or body), and the desired speed of results.
11. Throughout history, many brilliant minds have made pivotal contributions across various technical fields. The following lists highlight some of the most influential figures and their key achievements.
12. To gain comprehensive information about a manuscript, the process of **codicology** is used. This is the scientific study of manuscripts as physical objects and cultural artifacts, distinct from the study of the text itself.
13. While a "non-institutional custodian" is not a standard term in finance, it most closely refers to **non-custodial services and the individuals who use them**. In this model, the user acts as their own custodian, maintaining full control over their financial assets without relying on a traditional financial institution.
14. In the collection of manuscripts, a temporary receipt is not a physical location but an administrative procedure and designated holding area for newly acquired items. It is part of

the process of intake and ensures the proper cataloging, stabilization, and transfer of the manuscript to its permanent storage location within an archive or library.

15. The aim of textual criticism is to reconstruct the original text of a document by comparing all available manuscript copies to identify and remove transcription errors and variants. This scholarly practice seeks to produce a "critical edition" of the text that is as close as possible to the original wording and meaning, which can then be used for other literary and historical analysis.
16. In Nepal, the methods used to protect manuscripts range from traditional techniques that have been practiced for centuries to modern preservation and digitization efforts. Institutions like the National Archives of Nepal and the Asa Archives combine these approaches to preserve the country's rich written heritage.
17. A "codex" is a manuscript book, meaning it's a collection of handwritten pages bound together along one edge, forming the ancestor of the modern book. It was a significant advancement over scrolls because it allowed for easier reading, portability, and quick access to different sections.
18. Manuscriptology uses a variety of tools, including instruments for writing like **metal styluses and pens**, and implements for preparing the writing surface and finishing the manuscript, such as **burnishers, scissors, and ink-pots**. The specific tools vary based on the writing material, which could be palm leaves, birch bark, or paper, among others.
19. Qualifications for a scribe vary by context but generally include a minimum educational level (often high school), with specific requirements like being one academic step below the candidate for examination scribes. Medical scribes need additional skills such as a strong grasp of medical terminology, anatomy, and physiology, along with proficient typing and computer skills.
20. The publication of manuscripts provides significant advantages to the author, the academic community, and society at large. It solidifies a researcher's reputation, contributes to the expansion of collective knowledge, and ensures the wider dissemination of research findings for the benefit of all.
21. Manuscript libraries serve as irreplaceable repositories of human knowledge, acting as crucial links to past civilizations. They meticulously preserve a vast range of original, handwritten documents—from scientific and religious texts to personal letters, diaries, and historical records—offering researchers, historians, and scholars authentic, primary source materials that provide unique insights into the cultures, philosophies, and daily lives of past societies. Through specialized preservation and conservation techniques, these libraries safeguard fragile, aged materials from physical and biological deterioration, often making them available to a global audience through digitization efforts. By doing so, they not only protect irreplaceable artifacts from being lost forever but also ensure that this vast collective heritage remains accessible for study and can inform our understanding of the present and shape the future.
22. The Saraswathi Mahal Library in Thanjavur has illustrated manuscripts including the *Citra Ramayana*, illustrated *Rig Veda* manuscripts, *Gajasastra* (elephants), and *Aswasastra* (horses), and mythological pictures. Other illustrated items include botanical specimens, military costumes, and paintings based on a study of human and animal faces.

23. In manuscriptology, the main features of writing materials relate to their physical properties, preparation, and durability, which all influenced a text's appearance, preservation, and cultural context. Primary materials include palm leaves, birch bark, parchment, and handmade paper, each with distinct characteristics.
24. The field work for manuscript collection involves several key steps, starting with planning and preparation and ending with the documentation and preservation of the materials. This process is complex, especially for historically significant or oral-tradition-based manuscripts.
25. Manuscriptology is the scientific study of handwritten documents, particularly those with historical, cultural, or artistic value. This field examines the original artifacts of knowledge, providing an authentic and unmediated window into the past. Through a systematic process of collection, conservation, cataloging, and critical analysis, manuscriptology reveals historical narratives, preserves cultural heritage, and informs modern research across diverse fields. In an increasingly digital world, the study of these fragile, centuries-old documents is more critical than ever, as they contain irreplaceable information that risks being lost forever.
26. Manuscript libraries specialize in the collection, preservation, and study of historical handwritten documents. Their primary features center on the fragility and uniqueness of their holdings, which necessitates special handling, conservation methods, and access policies.